

SEED STENCILS: HIGH-ORDER FINITE DIFFERENCES AND RBF-FD THROUGH MATERIAL EDGES TOO STEEP FOR THE GRID

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ABSTRACT. Between a material whose parameters vary smoothly on the scale of the grid and one with a jump lies the case of an edge that is smooth but changes over a distance δ far smaller than the grid spacing h . Standard high-order finite differences sample the coefficients at the nodes and lose their order there until $h \lesssim \delta$, and the interface-aware stencils built for a jump do not apply, since there is no jump. We build stencils on the same equispaced (1-D) or scattered (2-D) nodes whose basis functions are not monomials but *seeds*: the $t = 0$ profiles of solutions of the wave equation that are polynomial in time, continued through the edge by ordinary differential equations in the coordinate normal to it. The seeds form an extended complete Chebyshev system for every δ , so the stencil solve is nonsingular, and as $\delta \rightarrow 0$ they reduce to the translated polynomial basis of the interface-aware stencils, so one construction covers the jump, the sub-grid edge and the resolved edge. In one dimension, standard fourth-order finite differences have a knee at $h = \delta$ while the seed stencils are fourth order at every resolution with the errors of the jump case. In two dimensions, for the elastic wave equation discretised with radial basis function-generated finite differences (RBF-FD) on scattered nodes, the seeds of a straight edge reduce to triangular systems of ordinary differential equations in the normal coordinate; the seed-augmented stencils are stable at the standard hyperviscosity, cut the error through an unresolved edge by up to an order of magnitude or more on the node sets tested, and lead to the rule: seed when $\delta \leq h$. The same seeds marched along the true normal handle a curved edge at the same accuracy on those node sets.

1. INTRODUCTION

High-order finite differences for wave propagation are in good shape at both ends of the range of media. When the material parameters vary smoothly on the scale of the grid, sampling them at the nodes costs nothing and a fourth-order stencil stays fourth order. When they jump, the stencils that straddle the jump can be rebuilt from piecewise polynomials that satisfy the interface conditions, and the scheme keeps its order on a grid that takes no notice of the interface [Mar16, MF17a]. Between the two lies a case that is neither. An edge can be smooth, so that no interface condition applies, and still change over a distance δ smaller than the grid spacing

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h . Any smooth model contains such edges once it is discretised coarsely enough, and any jump becomes one under the slightest smoothing.

A standard stencil through such an edge samples the coefficients at its nodes, sees a jump, and treats it as if the coefficients were smooth in between, which is the first-order failure of the jump case. It recovers only once $h \lesssim \delta$. In the one-dimensional experiment of Section 4, fourth-order finite differences (FD4) through an edge of width $\delta = 0.0025$ converge at rates 1.3 and 2.2 while $h > \delta$, drop by a factor 200 between $n = 400$ and $n = 800$ nodes ($h = 2\delta$ to $h = \delta$), and are fourth order after that: a knee at $h = \delta$. The two existing repairs do not reach this regime. The interface-aware stencils built for a jump are the $\delta \rightarrow 0$ limit of the right construction, as Section 3 shows, but their weights are off at first order in δ/h , by 10% of the largest weight at $\delta = h/10$ and 1% at $\delta = h/100$ in the example of Section 3.2. The other route expands the coefficients in Taylor series about the edge, as the interface-aware construction can for a wave speed that varies smoothly up to an interface [Mar16, MF17a] and as polynomial quasi-Trefftz spaces do in general [IGMS23]; but a profile such as $\tanh(x/\delta)$ has poles at $\pm i\pi\delta/2$, so the expansion converges only within $\pi\delta/2$ of the edge while the stencil reaches $2h \gg \delta$.

The construction of this paper keeps everything about the scheme except the basis functions of the stencils that see the edge. In place of the monomials $1, x, x^2, \dots$ a stencil is made exact on *seeds*: the $t = 0$ profiles of solutions of the wave equation that are polynomial in time. For the operator $L_u = \rho^{-1}\partial_x K \partial_x$ that governs the particle velocity, such a profile satisfies $L_u^m g = 0$ for some m , and with constant coefficients these profiles are exactly the polynomials. Anchored at the stencil's evaluation point x_e they form a chain, $\phi_0 = 1$, $K\phi'_1 = K(x_e)$, $L_u\phi_k = k(k-1)c_e^2\phi_{k-2}$ with $\phi_k(x_e) = \phi'_k(x_e) = 0$, which is integrated through the edge as a first-order system of ordinary differential equations that never differentiates the coefficients: one short march per stencil that sees the edge. Three facts make this a method rather than a trick. The seeds form an extended complete Chebyshev system for every δ , so the per-stencil solve is nonsingular on any distinct nodes, including at $\delta = 0$ where the seeds have kinks, with the conditioning of a Vandermonde matrix (condition numbers 20 to 60 from $\delta = 10^{-5}$ to 1). The truncation error of the seed stencil on a solution is $O(h^4 \partial_x \partial_t^4 u)$, bounded independently of δ , where FD4's $O(h^4 u^{(5)})$ carries $u^{(5)} \sim \delta^{-4}$ inside the edge. And the chain read in the weak sense across a jump is the translated Taylor basis of the interface-aware stencils, so one construction covers the jump (algebra), the sub-grid edge (an ODE march) and the resolved edge, where the seeds and the monomials give different weights, first order in h/δ apart, and both are fourth order on solutions.

The same idea carries to two dimensions, to the elastic wave equation on scattered nodes discretised with radial basis function-generated finite differences (RBF-FD). For a straight edge the material depends on the normal coordinate only, and an ansatz polynomial in the tangential coordinate turns

the chain into triangular systems of one-dimensional ODEs in the normal coordinate: all 30 seeds of one stencil, the monomials to degree four in each velocity component, march as one linear system of 600 states anchored at the evaluation node. The seeds replace the polynomial augmentation of the interface-aware RBF-FD stencils; the Gaussian part of the stencil and the coupled saddle-point solve stay as they are. For a curved edge the same seeds are marched along the true normal through the stencil's foot point, an approximation of zeroth order in the curvature, which is the one the jump stencils already make.

Contributions.

- (1) In one dimension: the seed chain, its nested kernels, its well-posedness as an extended complete Chebyshev system, and the jump construction as its $\delta \rightarrow 0$ limit (Section 3). On the same equispaced grid the seed stencils are fourth order at every resolution, with errors matching the jump case to three digits, while FD4 has its knee at $h = \delta$ (Section 4).
- (2) In two dimensions: the elastic seeds of a straight edge as triangular systems of ODEs in the normal coordinate, marched as one system per stencil; their assembly into seed rows for the elastic operator and hyperviscosity rows that annihilate the seeds; and the finding that the seeded operator is stable at the standard hyperviscosity at every edge width (Sections 5 and 6).
- (3) A rule: *seed when $\delta \leq h$* . Through an edge the nodes never resolve the seeds are fourth order at every resolution tested, $20\times$ below the standard scheme in the velocity and $67\times$ in the spurious tangential velocity at 19,600 nodes, at the seed operator's own resolution floor; the crossover is at $h \approx \delta$; and through a resolved edge the seed stencils are 1.4 to $2\times$ worse than the standard ones, so a resolved edge should not be seeded.
- (4) At oblique incidence the tangential dependence of the seeds is what acts: the full seeds beat the standard scheme by 1.4 to $1.9\times$ and the normal-only ablation is worse than doing nothing through a sharp edge. Every scheme converges at about order 2.5 there, the jump-aware stencils included, because the mode-converted shear waves sit at a pre-asymptotic floor on these node sets; the result is reported as it is.
- (5) Through a curved edge the jump stencils sit at the resolution floor at every node count, and the seeds marched along the true normal equal the flat seeds at their own floor, 2.2 to $7\times$ below the standard scheme at $\delta = 0.005$ and 3 to $12\times$ at $\delta = 0.0025$ on node sets up to 19,600 nodes; the zeroth-order geometry first shows at the finest of them.

- (6) An open implementation in Python with a test for every numerical routine, in which every figure and table of this paper is regenerated by a committed script from a results cache.

1.1. Relation to prior work. Three lines of prior work meet here, and the construction adds nothing to any of them taken alone. Stencils and elements built from local solutions of the operator are the fitted operators of the 1950s and 60s [AS55, Il'69, SG69, RST08] and the exact schemes that followed [Mic93, VSKO20]; the constant-flux seed in particular is the harmonic mean of Tikhonov and Samarskii [TS62, Sam01], the special elements of Babuška and Osborn [BO83, BCO94], the multiscale elements of Hou and Wu [HW97] and the harmonic coordinates of Owhadi and Zhang [OZ07], whose extension to the acoustic wave equation [OZ08] is the closest two-dimensional relative of what follows. Basis functions that are polynomial-in-time solutions of the wave equation are the Trefftz spaces of space–time discontinuous Galerkin methods [KMPS16, BGL17, MP18]; their quasi-Trefftz extension to variable coefficients [IGMS23, IGMP25, IG25] builds them by Taylor expansion at a point, the route Section 3 shows cannot reach an edge thinner than the stencil. For a jump, the interface-aware stencils this work generalises [Mar16, MFSC15, MF17a] stand beside the immersed interface [LL94, ZL97, SMP⁺23], explicit simplified interface [PL01, LP04] and summation-by-parts [MN06, DV14, GW25] treatments, all of which take the jump as given, where standard schemes are first order [Bro84, SV09, VLTR14]. The standing alternative in seismic and electromagnetic finite differences changes the medium rather than the stencil: coefficients averaged over a cell [Bac62, MDEN92, MKV⁺02, KMCK17, JZ24, FRR⁺06], thin structure homogenised [CGM10a, CGM10b], or the jump smoothed over a few cells [TE03, TE06, KWR22]. Those methods choose the smoothing width from the grid and accept a second-order error component at the interface [TE06]; here the width is a property of the medium, smaller than the grid, and the aim is the scheme's full order through it. We found no prior instance of stencils on an unchanged equispaced or scattered node set whose basis is continued through a sub-grid smooth edge by ordinary differential equations, nor of the observation that the construction reduces to the jump stencils as $\delta \rightarrow 0$; the search is logged in the repository's `LITERATURE.md`. We did not compare against the smoothing and averaging methods, and claim nothing relative to them.

Outline. Section 2 fixes the equations, the discretisations and the interface-aware stencils of the jump case that the seeds extend. Section 3 constructs the seeds in one dimension and proves what can be proved; Section 4 is the one-dimensional experiment. Sections 5 and 6 do the same in two dimensions, flat edges first, then oblique incidence and curved edges. Section 7 records the limitations and what we would do next.

2. SETTING

2.1. One dimension. The one-dimensional problem is the two-way wave equation in first-order form on the periodic interval $[-1, 1)$, with u the particle velocity and f the stress,

$$(1) \quad \rho u_t = f_x, \quad f_t = K u_x, \quad K = \rho c^2,$$

where $c(x) > 0$ is the wave speed and $\rho(x) > 0$ the density. Eliminating one field gives a second-order operator for each,

$$(2) \quad u_{tt} = L_u u, \quad L_u = \frac{1}{\rho} \partial_x K \partial_x; \quad f_{tt} = L_f f, \quad L_f = K \partial_x \frac{1}{\rho} \partial_x.$$

The medium is a background material $(c, \rho) = (1, 1)$ with one layer $[x_1, x_2) = [0, \frac{1}{2})$ of $(c, \rho) = (2, 1)$, so the contrast in K is 4 and the impedance ρc doubles. With edge width $\delta > 0$ the two edges of the layer are tanh transitions,

$$(3) \quad s(x) = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{m \in \mathbb{Z}} \left[\tanh \frac{x - x_1 + 2m}{\delta} - \tanh \frac{x - x_2 + 2m}{\delta} \right],$$

$$c = c_{\text{bg}} + (c_{\text{layer}} - c_{\text{bg}}) s, \quad \rho \text{ likewise},$$

summed over the periodic images so that the profile is smooth and periodic to rounding; $\delta = 0$ is the jump. For $\delta \ll h$ a stencil sees a jump between two of its nodes; for $\delta \gg h$ it sees a smooth function; the case in between is the subject of the paper.

The grid has n cell-centred nodes, $x_i = -1 + (i + \frac{1}{2})h$ with $h = 2/n$, and the semi-discrete system is

$$(4) \quad \rho_i \dot{u}_i = (D_f f)_i, \quad \dot{f}_i = K_i (D_u u)_i,$$

with $\rho_i = \rho(x_i)$, $K_i = K(x_i)$ and D_u, D_f two differentiation matrices with the sparsity of the centred five-point stencil. In the *naïve* scheme both are the standard fourth-order matrix, Fornberg's weights on the monomials [For88a]: the coefficients are sampled at the nodes and nothing else is done about the edge. In the *seed* scheme the rows whose stencils see a varying material are rebuilt as in Section 3, separately for u and for f because the two fields carry different continuity conditions; every other row is the standard one. Time stepping is the classical fourth-order Runge–Kutta method (RK4) with $\Delta t = 0.4 h / c_{\text{max}}$. Errors are relative ℓ^2 errors in the stress f at $t = 1$ against a reference solution (Section 4).

2.2. Two dimensions. The two-dimensional problem is the isotropic elastic wave equation in first-order form on the doubly periodic unit square, with velocities (u, v) and stresses $(\sigma_{xx}, \sigma_{xy}, \sigma_{yy})$,

$$(5) \quad \begin{aligned} \rho u_t &= \partial_x \sigma_{xx} + \partial_y \sigma_{xy}, & \partial_t \sigma_{xx} &= (\lambda + 2\mu) u_x + \lambda v_y, \\ \rho v_t &= \partial_x \sigma_{xy} + \partial_y \sigma_{yy}, & \partial_t \sigma_{xy} &= \mu (u_y + v_x), \\ & & \partial_t \sigma_{yy} &= \lambda u_x + (\lambda + 2\mu) v_y, \end{aligned}$$

with Lamé parameters $\lambda, \mu > 0$ and density $\rho > 0$, P- and S-wave speeds $c_p = \sqrt{(\lambda + 2\mu)/\rho}$ and $c_s = \sqrt{\mu/\rho}$, and $K = \lambda + 2\mu$ in the role of ρc^2 . (The implementation and the dissertation name the stresses f, g, h ; we write σ so that h can stay the node spacing.) The medium is a background $(\lambda, \mu, \rho) = (1, 1, 1)$ with a band $(4, 4, 2)$ between the two interfaces $y = y_0 + A \sin 2\pi x$, $y_0 = \frac{1}{4}$ and $\frac{1}{2}$, so c_p rises from $\sqrt{3}$ to $\sqrt{6}$ and c_s from 1 to $\sqrt{2}$ across each interface. The flat case is $A = 0$ and the curved case $A = 0.02$, the two geometries of the dissertation's elastic tests [Mar16]. With edge width $\delta > 0$ each interface becomes a tanh transition in the signed normal distance d to it, with the band's weight s summed over the periodic images in y ,

$$(6) \quad \begin{aligned} s &= \frac{1}{2} [1 + \tanh(d/\delta)], \\ (\lambda, \mu, \rho) &= (\lambda, \mu, \rho)_{\text{bg}} + [(\lambda, \mu, \rho)_{\text{band}} - (\lambda, \mu, \rho)_{\text{bg}}] s, \end{aligned}$$

so that λ, μ and ρ , and hence K , are linear in the weight while c_p and c_s are not. For a flat interface d is the vertical offset; for a curved one it is the true signed distance, through the foot point on the curve. Two edges a gap g apart reach only $\tanh(g/2\delta)$ of the contrast between them, so the band's width of $\frac{1}{4}$ bounds the edge widths we can pose; nothing here approaches that bound.

Node sets. A node set of n nodes is built as in [MF17a]: six fixed rows of nodes hug each interface, three on each side at normal distances $(\frac{1}{2} + j\frac{\sqrt{3}}{2})h$, $j = 0, 1, 2$, with alternate rows shifted by half a spacing so that the rows straddle the interface in a hexagonal pattern, and every other node is placed by a simulated electrostatic repulsion from a random start. The straddling rows were found empirically to be what keeps the interface-aware stencils stable, and we keep them for the seed stencils. Throughout, $h = n^{-1/2}$ denotes the mean spacing, and convergence rates are measured in it; the node counts are $n = 2500, 4900, 10,000$ and $19,600$, so h runs from 0.02 to 0.0071.

RBF-FD. For a stencil of s nodes $x_1, \dots, x_s$ about an evaluation node x_c , the weights w of a linear operator $\mathcal{L}$ solve the saddle-point system

$$(7) \quad \begin{bmatrix} A & P \\ P^\top & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} w \\ w_* \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \mathcal{L} \varphi(|x - x_i|)|_{x_c} \\ \mathcal{L} p_m(x)|_{x_c} \end{bmatrix},$$

with $A_{ij} = \varphi(|x_i - x_j|)$ for the Gaussian $\varphi(r) = e^{-(\varepsilon r)^2}$, $P_{im} = p_m(x_i)$ over the bivariate monomials p_m up to a chosen degree, evaluated in coordinates scaled by the stencil radius, and w_* discarded. The constraint rows make the weights exact on the polynomials, which take over from the Gaussians under refinement, and the shape parameter is scaled to the local spacing, $\varepsilon = 0.4/d$ with d the distance from x_c to its third-nearest neighbour.¹ Away from the

¹The published description [MF17a] says the nearest neighbour; the original MATLAB and the present implementation use the third-nearest. The choice fixes a constant in εh and nothing else.

interfaces every stencil has 30 nodes and is exact on the polynomials of degree ≤ 4 ; stencils across a jump have 19 nodes and degree ≤ 3 , with the piecewise basis of Section 2.3. Two matrices D_x and D_y result, and the $5n \times 5n$ block operator of (5) is assembled from them with the material coefficients evaluated at each row's node. A small hyperviscosity $\gamma\Delta^3$ is added to every field to move the spurious eigenvalues of the RBF-FD operator into the left half-plane [FL11]: the Δ^3 stencils are built on the same nodes and the same basis as the derivative stencils, and $\gamma = \gamma_0 (h/h_0)^5$ with $\gamma_0 = 2.4 \times 10^{-11}$ at $h_0 = 0.02$, which keeps $\gamma\Delta^3$ proportional to $1/h$ like the wave operator so that one CFL number serves every n . Time stepping is RK4 with $\Delta t = 0.5 h/c_{p,\max}$, capped where necessary by the hyperviscosity spectrum.

Pulses and errors. The normal-incidence runs send a plane P-wave pulse, Gaussian in y with sharpness 15, from $y = 0.875$ in the background towards $-y$ through both interfaces; the true solution then has $u \equiv 0$, and the largest $|u|$ a scheme produces is a clean measure of what its stencils do at the edges. The oblique runs send a plane-wave train at 26.6° to the normal (direction $(1, 2)$), which mode-converts at each interface. Errors are relative ℓ^2 errors in v at $t = 1$ against the references described with each experiment in Section 6, together with the spurious u at normal incidence and the relative error in u otherwise.

2.3. Interface-aware stencils for a jump. The seeds extend the interface-aware stencils of [Mar16, MF17a], which we summarise in the form the later sections use; the derivations are in those references.

One dimension. Write (1) as $\partial_t(u, f)^\top = \mathcal{D}(u, f)^\top$ with the block operator

$$\mathcal{D} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \rho^{-1}\partial_x \\ K\partial_x & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Across a material jump, u and f are continuous for all time, hence so are all their time derivatives, and $\partial_t^k(u, f)^\top = \mathcal{D}^k(u, f)^\top$ converts each of those conditions into a condition on spatial derivatives, with the material of the side it is evaluated on: $\mathcal{D}_L^k(u_L, f_L)^\top = \mathcal{D}_R^k(u_R, f_R)^\top$ at the jump for $k = 0, 1, 2, \dots$. Expanding u and f on each side as polynomials of degree four about the jump and imposing these conditions for $k \leq 4$ gives a square *continuity matrix* per side, $C_L a_L = C_R a_R$ on the coefficient vectors. Keeping the monomials on one side and translating them across with $C_R^{-1}C_L$ yields the *translated basis*: piecewise polynomials, one per monomial, that satisfy every continuity condition. A stencil whose nodes straddle both edges of a layer thinner than the stencil chains two translations. The stencil weights are then the ones that differentiate every basis function exactly at the evaluation point, a small dense solve per stencil, and the f basis is built by the same construction rather than from the u basis through the operator, which would lose an order. This is the scheme that Section 4 calls the jump case; the even continuity conditions relate a field to itself and the odd ones route through the other field, a pattern the seeds inherit.

Two dimensions. A stencil near an interface works in a local frame: origin at the nearest interface point, x' along the tangent and y' along the normal. The isotropic system (5) keeps its form under rotation, so in that frame the rotated fields obey the same equations and the interface is, locally, $y' = 0$. The velocities (u', v') and the tractions $(\sigma'_{x'y'}, \sigma'_{y'y'})$ are continuous across it for all time; the remaining stress $\sigma'_{x'x'}$ may jump. Expand (u', v') on each side in the monomials of (x', y') up to degree four, convert the time derivatives of the continuous quantities through powers of the block operator (even powers relate velocities to velocities, odd powers route through the stresses), and match the coefficients of the powers of x' at each order: a square continuity matrix per side, a translated velocity basis, truncated to degree three. The stress basis is generated from it by applying the stress rows of the operator on each side and dropping the three columns that come from rigid motions, 27 functions in all. The RBF-FD solve (7) then couples the fields: the stress rates need weights on u' and v' data jointly, the velocity rates weights on the three stresses jointly, with the Gaussian block repeated on the diagonal and the piecewise basis in place of P . The weights are rotated back to the laboratory frame, and the hyperviscosity stencils across the interface use the same piecewise basis, which the original work found necessary for accuracy. The interface is treated as locally flat in the frame; carrying curvature into the continuity conditions by expanding the interface in x' is possible [MF17a] but was not used by the original code and is not used here. This is the approximation we call zeroth order in the curvature, and the curved seeds of Section 5 make the same one.

2.4. Scope of the implementation. The experiments run on a Python reimplementations of the 2016–2017 methods (NumPy and SciPy, with a test for every numerical routine) that reproduces the constructions above and restructures the code. Of the original two-dimensional code it leaves out three things: the *triple stencils* that see both interfaces of a band thinner than one stencil (the band here is $\frac{1}{4}$ wide and none is needed), the variable Lamé parameters inside the band of the published test case (the band here is a constant material), and the finite-difference far field of the FD/RBF-FD hybrid (every stencil here is RBF-FD). Point sources and the Marmousi model are out of scope. In one dimension the implementation takes piecewise-constant materials, with the smooth edges of (3), and not the dissertation’s smoothly varying background, because the exact reference of the jump case, a ray sum, needs constant pieces; the published treatment of a wave speed that varies smoothly up to an interface, a degree-four Taylor expansion of c about the interface point [Mar16, MF17a], is the Taylor route of Section 3 and is not ported. Everything is fourth order (FD4 in one dimension, degree four away from and degree three across the edges in two) at one material contrast; Section 7 returns to both restrictions.

3. SEEDS IN ONE DIMENSION

3.1. Seeds as the profiles of solutions polynomial in time. [Stub, #56: $u_{tt} = L_u u$ with $L_u = \rho^{-1} \partial_x K \partial_x$; the chain $\phi_0 = 1$, $K\phi'_1 = K(x_e)$, $L_u \phi_k = k(k-1)c_e^2 \phi_{k-2}$ with $\phi_k(x_e) = \phi'_k(x_e) = 0$; the even/odd (u/f) alternation; first-order form so that K is never differentiated.]

3.2. Nested kernels and the jump as the limit. [Stub, #56: $\{1\} \subset \ker L_u \subset \{L_u g = \text{const}\} \subset \ker L_u^2 \subset \dots$; the seed weights converge to the interface-aware weights at first order in δ .]

3.3. Well-posedness. [Stub, #56: the seeds are an extended complete Chebyshev system (Pólya, Karlin–Studden), so the per-stencil solve is non-singular on any distinct nodes for every δ .]

3.4. Why the Taylor route does not reach a sub-grid edge. [Stub, #56: notes §1.5; the quasi-Trefftz comparison.]

3.5. Stencil assembly and cost. [Stub, #56: the Fornberg-style solve on the seeds; one ODE march per stencil.]

4. ONE-DIMENSIONAL RESULTS

[Stub, #57: test problem (medium, contrast, pulse, $\delta \in \{0, 0.0025, 0.01\}$); the Fourier pseudo-spectral reference; the knee of standard FD4 at $h = \delta$; seeds fourth order at every n with the jump case's errors; condition numbers 20–60 from $\delta = 10^{-5}$ to 1.]

5. SEEDS IN TWO DIMENSIONS

5.1. Design: a straight edge. [Stub, #58: the x' -polynomial ansatz turns the 2-D chain into triangular systems of 1-D ODEs in the normal coordinate; tangential dependence stays polynomial; tractions as flux variables.]

5.2. The elastic seeds. [Stub, #58: all 30 seeds of one stencil marched as one 600-state system anchored at the evaluation node; constant-material, jump-limit, residual and conditioning checks.]

5.3. Stencil assembly. [Stub, #58: 19-node seed rows for the elastic operator; Δ^3 rows on the naïve 30-node footprint with the seeds annihilated; the seeded region (19δ) and its trim.]

5.4. Curved edges. [Stub, #58: route (a), the seeds marched along the true normal through the foot point, zeroth order in curvature, the same approximation as the jump stencils; what route (b) would be.]

6. TWO-DIMENSIONAL RESULTS

6.1. Test problems and references. [Stub, #59: 1-D spectral at normal incidence; Fourier-in- x for oblique; product-grid for the curved $\delta > 0$; the 122,500-node jump-aware run for the curved $\delta = 0$.]

6.2. Naive baseline. *[Stub, #59: the resolution floor hides the edge error in v ; the spurious u separates unresolved from resolved edges $10\times$ more sharply.]*

6.3. Stability. *[Stub, #59: spectra at $n = 900$ and 2500 , standard γ , every δ , flat and curved.]*

6.4. The flat sweep and the rule. *[Stub, #59: seeds fourth order through $\delta = 0.0025$ at every n , $20\times$ below naive in v and $67\times$ in spurious u at $19,600$ nodes; crossover at $h \approx \delta$; a resolved edge $1.4\text{--}2\times$ worse seeded; the rule: seed when $\delta \leq h$.]*

6.5. Oblique incidence. *[Stub, #59: seeds $1.4\text{--}1.9\times$ over naive at 26.6° , the ablation worse than naive, every scheme about 2.5 from the converted- S floor, reported as it is.]*

6.6. The curved edge. *[Stub, #59: jump stencils at the resolution floor at every n ; seeds equal the flat seeds at their own floor, $2.2\text{--}7\times$ ($\delta = 0.005$) and $3\text{--}12\times$ ($\delta = 0.0025$) below naive; where route (a)'s geometry first shows; the fine-end rate and the trim; costs.]*

7. DISCUSSION

7.1. Limitations. *[Stub, #60: FD4 / degree 3 only, one contrast, at most $19,600$ nodes, the flat translation symmetry unexploited, one march per stencil, the port's exclusions.]*

7.2. Future work. *[Stub, #60: curvilinear evaluation of the marched seeds; seeded-width tuning; the seeds' true Δ^3 as hyperviscosity right-hand sides; Mühlbach's recurrence in place of the dense solve; higher order; other contrasts; thin bands; variable Lamé parameters; 3-D; the oblique train on the curved geometry.]*

7.3. Conclusions. *[Stub, #60: the rule and the one-construction claim, in #53's wording.]*

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[Stub, #62: Bengt Fornberg, for the 2016-era work this construction extends (the dissertation and the interface treatment of [MF17a]); the AI-assistance statement crediting Claude (Fable 5.1) for the re-derivation, the code and the drafting.]

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